

Extinction

Eventually, the magma chamber below the surface empties out. No more eruptions take place, and the volcano is said to be extinct. It will be eroded away just like any other mountain.

Sleeping volcanoes

When a volcano has not erupted for decades but is expected to erupt in the future, it is said to be dormant. Some volcanoes stay dormant for centuries.

Magma that reaches the Earth's surface is called lava. It cools as it flows out of the volcano.

Over time, magma chambers start to empty out.

See also

To learn more about Earth's plates and how they move, see continents (22–23) and mountains (28–29).

Giant's Causeway

When lava cools down, it can form perfect geometrical shapes, including six-sided columns. A spectacular example of this is the Giant's Causeway in Northern Ireland.



Pompeii

In 79 CE, the deadly eruption of Mount Vesuvius in Italy destroyed the city of Pompeii. The remains of the people who lived there are preserved in hardened volcanic ash.

